

**UNITED STATES OF AMERICA
BEFORE THE
FEDERAL ENERGY REGULATORY COMMISSION**

Interconnection of Large Loads to the Interstate)
Transmission System)

Docket No. RM26-4-000

COMMENTS OF GOVERNOR JOSH SHAPIRO AND GOVERNOR GLENN YOUNGKIN

We write in response to the Secretary of the Department of Energy’s (DOE) October 23, 2025 letter to FERC regarding the rapid growth of Large Load Additions (LLAs) to our nation’s electricity grid. In that letter, the Secretary emphasized three key goals: ensuring affordable electricity for American consumers and industries, protecting the reliability of the grid, and providing a timely, orderly, and efficient process for LLA interconnection. We share each of these important goals, and stand ready to work with FERC to expedite both generator- and load-side interconnection while lowering the cost of power in our Commonwealths and across the region.

We welcome a strong collaboration between FERC and the states, particularly in setting uniform national standards that serve as a floor, not a ceiling, for state and private sector creativity. While we strongly believe it is essential for states to retain significant jurisdiction in this area, we recognize that the timely interconnection of certain LLAs is a matter of national security and national economic wellbeing. We also recognize the distinctions that you have already drawn that affirm the states’ longstanding authority to regulate interconnection: LLAs not connecting directly to the transmission system, retail sales and rates, and the siting, expansion, and modification of both generator and load facilities. We note that the Secretary’s letter defines LLAs as any load greater than 20MW “consistent with how the Commission has defined large generation resources.” While we understand why DOE would seek symmetry in these two definitions, we believe that the limit as proposed would substantially impact traditional state jurisdiction over loads. We look forward to further public participation on what characteristics and size best serve to implicate shared state and federal jurisdiction in this regard.

Aside from these jurisdictional concerns, on the majority of the substance of the Secretary’s proposal, we write to express support, and to suggest complementary additions. Similar to the compromise LLA proposal developed by four bipartisan PJM governors that is currently being considered by the PJM Board of Managers and other related proposals, this framework would provide strong incentives for LLAs to invest in nearby new energy generation and storage resources, to curtail during tight market conditions, and to take responsibility for their network upgrade costs. It would also similarly require that hybrid facilities be studied more efficiently.

However, this proposal could be even more impactful if FERC were to develop national standards and guidelines for RTO LLA forecasts. As Commissioner Rosner has recognized, load forecasts in recent years have been challenged by the novel scale and scope of LLAs. In some cases, for example, these forecasts have failed to account for the common practice of a single LLA applying for interconnection in multiple utility service territories. As a result, some recent load forecasts have markedly exceeded real-world constraints on load construction, such as the available supply

of semiconductor chips, risking significant overbuild and associated cost increases for consumers. FERC's national perspective across utilities and states could help account for these constraints and make load forecasts more accurate.

We also respectfully suggest that FERC examine interconnection study processes, and whether it should be considered not just and reasonable for an interconnection request to take longer than six months, as [recently requested](#) by thirteen governors of both parties. While expedited processes for generators paired with LLAs can help solve some near-term challenges in the capacity market, a more general solution to interconnection queue delays is critical to enable the important investments in manufacturing, AI, and infrastructure that are needed for the United States to compete and win.

We thank you for your attention to this important issue. Our teams stand ready to answer any questions regarding these concepts, and to work with you to address LLAs in ways that harmonize state and federal oversight without undermining state jurisdiction.

Sincerely,



Governor Josh Shapiro
Commonwealth of Pennsylvania



Governor Glenn Youngkin
Commonwealth of Virginia

Dated: November 21, 2025